

Plan Review

JM Sites • August 5, 2026

Summary

The business plan for JM Sites presents a compelling vision. The strategy targets a clear market gap. The founder combines technical expertise with strong business acumen. The tiered service model provides immediate cash flow. The planned software product offers scalable growth. This dual approach creates a resilient business model.

Risks & Concerns

The primary risk involves founder capacity. The business relies entirely on one person for sales and technical delivery. This creates a significant growth bottleneck. The financial forecast also omits the requested grant funding. The budget lacks specific allocations for software development. This makes the SiteSignal product launch appear underfunded. Funders will want to see these development costs reflected in the projections.

Conclusion

The plan establishes a strong foundation for a profitable digital agency. Aligning the financial data with the funding narrative will complete the package. The business is well positioned for sustainable growth.

Detailed Feedback

Strong

8

Needs Improvement

2

Attention Required

0

Not Started

0

Executive Summary

Strong

A concise overview of your entire business plan that captures your value proposition, target market, competitive advantage, and financial highlights. This is often the first (and sometimes only) section funders read.

What works

The summary clearly defines the target market. It explains the core problem effectively. The transition from service revenue to product revenue is well articulated.

What isn't working

The summary omits the specific funding amount requested. It also lacks a brief mention of the projected revenue for the first year. Funders need these numbers immediately to evaluate the opportunity.

Suggestions

1 Add the funding request

Include the specific grant amount being sought. This sets clear expectations for the reader.

Try saying it like this:

The business is seeking a \$50,000 non-dilutive grant to accelerate the commercialization of the SiteSignal platform.

2 Include financial highlights

Add a sentence summarizing the revenue projections. This proves the business model has strong growth potential.

Try saying it like this:

The firm projects \$25,000 in first-year revenue, growing to \$173,000 by year three as recurring subscriptions scale.

3 Define SiteSignal briefly

Explain what SiteSignal actually does. This clarifies the transition from a service business to a product business.

Try saying it like this:

SiteSignal is a proprietary software platform that automates website performance monitoring and lead scoring for professional service firms.

Problem & Solution

Strong

An explanation of what problem your business solves and why it matters, followed by how your specific solution addresses that problem. The Problem should focus on market gaps and customer pain points. The Solution should explain your approach, what makes it unique, and how it directly addresses the problems you've identified.

What works

The narrative perfectly captures the credibility gap faced by clients. The solution directly addresses specific client pain points. The tiered service model offers flexible entry points for different budgets.

What isn't working

The solution section lacks specific details about the SiteSignal product. This makes the future software revenue stream hard to evaluate. Funders need to understand how the service business transitions into a product business.

Suggestions

1 Introduce the software product

Provide a brief explanation of the SiteSignal product in the solution section. This sets up the future revenue stream early in the plan.

Try saying it like this:

The business is also developing SiteSignal, a proprietary software platform that automates website performance monitoring.

2 Illustrate technical debt

Include a brief example of a common technical debt issue. This makes the problem more tangible for non-technical funders.

Try saying it like this:

For example, many firms rely on outdated WordPress plugins that increase load times and create severe security vulnerabilities.

3 Quantify the problem

Quantify the impact of poor messaging. This strengthens the argument that the problem is worth solving.

Try saying it like this:

Industry data shows that B2B buyers leave websites within 15 seconds if the value proposition is unclear.

Target Market

Strong

A detailed analysis of who your customers are, how large the market is, and why you can capture a meaningful share. Include demographics, psychographics, and market segmentation.

What works

The focus on boutique consultancies is highly strategic. The employee count criteria provides clear boundaries. The geographic focus ensures manageable direct outreach.

What isn't working

The estimate of 500 to 1000 qualified prospects lacks a cited source. Funders prefer market sizing data backed by industry research. The section also lacks detail on the specific decision-makers being targeted.

Suggestions

1 Cite market sizing data

Replace the estimated prospect numbers with verifiable data from a government or industry source.

Try saying it like this:

According to the Australian Bureau of Statistics, over 800 management consultancies operate within this revenue bracket in New South Wales.

2 Identify the decision-maker

Specify exactly who within the target companies will sign the contract. This proves you understand the sales cycle.

Try saying it like this:

The primary buyers are typically Managing Partners or Founders who recognize that poor digital branding is costing them contracts.

3 Define client revenue criteria

Add a revenue range for ideal clients to further qualify the target market.

Try saying it like this:

These firms typically generate between \$1 million and \$10 million in annual revenue, providing ample budget for digital investments.

Competition

Strong

An honest assessment of direct and indirect competitors, their strengths and weaknesses, and how you differentiate. Funders want to see you understand the competitive landscape.

What works

The analysis accurately identifies the middle-ground dilemma. The competitive advantages are clear and actionable. The focus on performance engineering creates a strong defensive moat.

What isn't working

The section does not name specific competing agencies. The analysis relies on broad categories rather than actual market players. Funders prefer concrete examples of local competition.

Suggestions

1 Identify direct competitors

Name actual competing agencies in the local market. Funders want to see direct comparisons with real businesses.

Try saying it like this:

Direct competitors include local boutique agencies like Sydney Digital and WebForce, which typically charge minimum retainers exceeding \$5,000.

2 Address agency down-market risks

Explain how the business will defend against larger agencies moving down-market. This shows foresight regarding market shifts.

Try saying it like this:

The business maintains an advantage over enterprise agencies by offering direct access to senior strategists without account manager friction.

3 Detail DIY limitations

Highlight the specific technical limitations of DIY builders. This strengthens the argument for custom development.

Try saying it like this:

DIY platforms suffer from bloated codebases that negatively impact search engine rankings and frustrate executive-level users.

Business Model

Strong

How your company makes money. Include revenue streams, pricing strategy, unit economics, and customer acquisition costs.

What works

The mix of project fees and retainers ensures steady cash flow. The financial data shows strong gross margins. The planned transition to software revenue is highly strategic.

What isn't working

The pricing strategy for SiteSignal is missing from the narrative. The financial data shows subscription revenue, but the text does not explain the unit economics. Funders need to understand how the SaaS product is priced.

Suggestions

1 Explain SaaS pricing

Detail the specific price points for the software product. This validates the revenue projections in the forecast.

Try saying it like this:

SiteSignal operates on a tiered subscription model starting at \$199 per month for basic monitoring.

2 Define average project size

State the average revenue per custom project. This helps funders understand the sales volume required to hit targets.

Try saying it like this:

Custom website development projects average \$5,500, providing significant upfront cash flow to fund operations.

3 Quantify retainer pricing

Provide the baseline pricing for monthly retainers. This clarifies the recurring revenue model.

Try saying it like this:

Ongoing optimization partnerships are billed at a flat rate of \$450 per month.

Marketing Strategy

Strong

Your go-to-market plan including positioning, channels, customer acquisition strategy, and sales process.

What works

The direct outreach strategy is highly cost-effective. The digital audit approach provides immediate value to prospects. The sales pipeline stages are clearly defined and logical.

What isn't working

The financial forecast shows only \$2,000 for marketing in the first year. This budget seems too low to support the described outreach tools and networking events. The narrative needs to explain how this lean budget will achieve the stated goals.

Suggestions

1 Justify the lean budget

Explain exactly how the small marketing budget will be spent. This proves the customer acquisition strategy is viable.

Try saying it like this:

The marketing budget relies on low-cost organic channels, utilizing \$150 monthly for premium LinkedIn tools and CRM software.

2 Set conversion targets

Add specific target metrics for the sales funnel. This shows funders you understand pipeline velocity.

Try saying it like this:

The business targets a 20% conversion rate from initial digital audits to signed development contracts.

3 Quantify referral expectations

Estimate the percentage of business expected from referral networks. This highlights the importance of these partnerships.

Try saying it like this:

Strategic partnerships with local IT consultants will generate an estimated 30% of new business leads.

Operations

Strong

How your business actually runs day-to-day. Include facilities, technology, key processes, and partnerships.

What works

The remote-first model keeps overhead costs low. The technology stack is modern and highly scalable. The milestone timeline provides clear accountability for the first year of operations.

What isn't working

The narrative mentions future hardware upgrades and new testing devices. The financial forecast shows no asset purchases after February 2026. This creates a discrepancy. Funders will question

how the business plans to fund these operational upgrades.

Suggestions

1 Align equipment purchases

Update the narrative to match the financial forecast regarding equipment purchases. This shows funders that operational plans are grounded in financial reality.

Try saying it like this:

The business will utilize existing high-performance workstations for the first three years to maximize cash flow.

2 Define facility triggers

Add specific dates or triggers for moving to a co-working space. This demonstrates a proactive approach to scaling operations.

Try saying it like this:

The business will transition to a dedicated co-working space once monthly recurring revenue exceeds \$15,000.

3 Add a funding milestone

Include a milestone for securing the grant funding mentioned in the plan. This ties the operational timeline to the financial strategy.

Try saying it like this:

Submit applications for state innovation grants to fund SiteSignal development by November 2026.

Team

Strong

The people who will execute this plan. Include founders, key hires, advisors, and any relevant experience or track record.

What works

The founder profile highlights highly relevant technical skills. The sole proprietorship structure matches the current operational scale. The strategic use of external advisors mitigates operational risk.

What isn't working

The advisors section lacks specific names or professional backgrounds. Anonymous advisors do not build credibility with funders. The plan also lacks detail on how the founder will manage the workload before hiring contractors.

Suggestions

1 Detail advisor backgrounds

Provide specific details about the advisors' professional experience. This proves the business has access to high-level guidance.

Try saying it like this:

The advisory board includes a former technical director from Atlassian and a senior partner from a Sydney-based accounting firm.

2 Address capacity management

Explain how the founder will handle overflow work. This reassures funders that the business will not bottleneck.

Try saying it like this:

To manage capacity, the founder utilizes a vetted network of freelance developers for routine coding tasks.

3 Highlight past successes

Add specific metrics or achievements from the founder's past experience. This builds immediate authority.

Try saying it like this:

The founder previously led digital transformation projects for three major Sydney consultancies, resulting in a 40% increase in lead generation.

Financial Projections

Developing

Your financial forecasts including revenue projections, expenses, profitability timeline, and key assumptions.

What works

The revenue growth projections are realistic and steady. The direct costs align with the stated technology stack. The cash flow remains positive throughout the entire forecast period.

What isn't working

The forecast lacks development costs for SiteSignal. Building a SaaS product requires significant investment. The projections show zero contractor costs in the first year. This makes the product launch timeline seem unrealistic. The cash flow statement also omits the requested grant funding.

Suggestions

1 Budget for software development

Add specific expense line items for building SiteSignal. Funders know software products require upfront capital.

Try saying it like this:

The financial forecast includes a \$15,000 allocation in year one for specialized backend development contractors.

2 Include grant funding in cash flow

Update the forecast tool to include the requested grant as an investment or other income source.

Try saying it like this:

The cash flow statement reflects a \$50,000 grant injection in the third quarter of 2026.

3 Explain the SiteSignal revenue jump

Provide context for why subscription revenue scales so quickly in the second year.

Try saying it like this:

SiteSignal revenue grows rapidly in 2027 as existing agency clients are transitioned onto the new subscription platform.

Funding Request

Developing

How much capital you need, how you'll use it, expected return for funders, and your exit strategy.

What works

The use of funds is clearly categorized. The focus on commercializing SiteSignal is highly strategic. The bootstrapped history demonstrates strong financial discipline.

What isn't working

The plan does not state the specific grant amount needed. The financial forecast does not include any grant income. The narrative mentions hardware upgrades that are missing from the cash flow statement.

Suggestions

1 Quantify the funding request

State the exact amount of grant funding required. Funders cannot evaluate an unquantified request.

Try saying it like this:

The business is applying for a \$50,000 state innovation grant to fund the final development of SiteSignal.

2 Detail the development budget

Break down exactly how the grant money will be spent. This builds trust and shows financial discipline.

Try saying it like this:

Grant funds will cover \$30,000 in specialized backend contractor fees and \$20,000 for initial marketing campaigns.

3 Name target grant programs

Identify specific grants the business is targeting. This proves the funding strategy is researched and viable.

Try saying it like this:

The business is actively pursuing the Minimum Viable Product grant through the New South Wales government.

Funder Q&A Prep

Challenging questions funders will ask about your plan. Use the pro-tips to prepare strong, confident answers.

- 1** Your plan relies heavily on a single founder for both sales and technical delivery. How will you manage capacity if you secure multiple large contracts simultaneously?

Pro-Tip: Discuss your network of specialized contractors. Explain how you will delegate technical tasks while maintaining senior-level client strategy.

- 2** You are seeking grant funding to build SiteSignal, but your financial forecast shows zero contractor or development costs in the first year. How are you building this product?

Pro-Tip: Explain your low-code technology stack. Clarify if the founder is building the MVP personally or if the forecast needs updating to reflect development costs.

- 3** Your marketing budget is only \$2,000 for the first year, yet you project \$25,000 in revenue growing to \$91,000. How will you acquire clients with such a small budget?

Pro-Tip: Detail your organic outreach strategy. Emphasize that high-ticket B2B sales rely on targeted networking and personalized audits rather than expensive ad campaigns.

- 4** The narrative mentions seeking non-dilutive grant funding, but this cash injection is missing from your projected statements. What is your baseline plan if the grant is denied?

Pro-Tip: Highlight your bootstrapped profitability. Explain that the service revenue sustains the business, and the grant simply accelerates the software product timeline.

- 5** How will you convince established professional service firms to trust a newly launched sole proprietorship over an established digital agency?

Pro-Tip: Focus on your niche specialization. Emphasize that agencies offer generic solutions, while you offer deep expertise specifically tailored to B2B consultancies.

6

Your financial model shows significant growth in ongoing support retainers. What specific value will you provide monthly to prevent clients from churning?

Pro-Tip: Detail the ongoing optimization process. Mention specific deliverables like monthly conversion rate reports, A/B testing, and continuous performance engineering.